SKILLHUB MARKETPLACE

Freelance Services Marketplace — Project Report | Chapters 1–3

HTML · CSS · JavaScript · PHP · MySQL

CHAPTER 1

Introduction

Background,problemframing,objectives,scopeand expected outcomes of the marketplace

1.1

Background

- The freelance economy has experienced rapid growth in recent years due to advancements in digital technology, widespread internet access, and the increasing acceptance of remote work. Organizations and individuals now prefer hiring freelancers for short-term or project-based tasks instead of maintaining full-time employees. Services such as graphic design, web development, content writing, digital marketing, video editing, and software development are commonly outsourced to freelancers.
- Despite this growth, both clients and freelancers face several challenges. Clients often struggle to find skilled and trustworthy professionals within their budget, while freelancers find it difficult to secure consistent and genuine work opportunities. A Freelance Service Marketplace aims to bridge this gap by providing a centralized platform where clients and freelancers can interact, collaborate, and complete projects efficiently. The platform ensures secure communication, transparent transactions, and effective project management.

1.2

Problem Statement

- In the current freelance ecosystem, clients often face difficulties in identifying reliable freelancers due to the lack of proper verification and transparency. On the other hand, freelancers struggle to find legitimate projects and often encounter issues such as delayed payments or unfair competition.
- Existing platforms also present several limitations, including high commission fees, complicated user interfaces, and limited support for beginners or local freelancers. These challenges highlight the need for a system that is secure, cost-effective, easy to use, and accessible to a wider audience.

1.3

Existing Scenario

- Several freelance platforms such as Fiverr, Upwork, Freelancer, and Toptal dominate the market. These platforms provide features like job posting, bidding systems, freelancer profiles, and secure payment gateways.
- However, these platforms also have drawbacks. High service charges reduce freelancers' earnings, while intense competition makes it difficult for new users to establish themselves. Additionally, complex workflows and strict policies can discourage users from fully utilizing these platforms. There is also limited focus on supporting local freelancers or small-scale projects.

1.4

Need of the Project

- **The development of a Freelance Service Marketplace is essential to address the limitations of existing systems and improve the overall freelance experience. The project is needed to:**
-
- Provide a centralized platform that connects clients with skilled freelancers efficiently.
- Ensure secure communication channels between users.
- Enable safe and transparent online payment systems.
- Simplify the process of posting projects and submitting bids.
- Reduce dependency on intermediaries and minimize commission costs.
- Encourage participation from local and beginner freelancers.
- Improve trust and reliability through ratings and reviews.

1.5

Objectives

1

Role-based access
Separate registration and dashboards for Client, Freelancer and Admin.

2

Gig marketplace
Let freelancers list gigs with Basic/Standard/Premium packages.

3

End-to-end orders
Support order placement, tracking and file delivery.

4

Secure communication
In-order AJAX chat between client and freelancer.

5

Payments & reviews
Simulated payment flow plus star ratings after completion.

6

Platform oversight
Admin dashboard for users, gigs, categories and disputes.

1.6

Scope

- The Freelance Service Marketplace system is designed to serve multiple types of users, including freelancers, clients, and administrators. The platform supports various functionalities such as user registration, login authentication, profile management, project posting, bidding, messaging, payment processing, and feedback systems.
- The system can be expanded in the future to include advanced features such as AI-based recommendations, mobile applications, and integration with third-party tools. It can also be adapted for different industries and service categories.

1.7

Expected Outcome

- **The implementation of this system is expected to deliver the following outcomes**:
-
- Faster and more efficient hiring processes for clients.
- Increased job opportunities for freelancers across different skill levels.
- Secure and transparent financial transactions.
- Improved communication and collaboration between users.
- Enhanced user satisfaction through a simple and intuitive interface.
- Growth of the freelance ecosystem by supporting new and local talent.

1.8

SDG Mapping

1

SDG 8 — Decent Work & Economic Growth

Enablesfreelancerstoearnthrough flexible, self-managed gig work.

2

SDG 9 — Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure

Builds adigitalplatforminfrastructurefor local service commerce.

3

SDG 10 — Reduced Inequalities

Gives freelancers without global-platform access an equal opportunity to earn online.

CHAPTER 2

Literature Survey

Reviewingexistingmarketplaceplatforms,researchandthegapSkillHub fills

2.1

Introduction

- The literature survey involves studying existing research papers, journals, and online platforms related to freelance marketplaces. This helps in understanding current technologies, methodologies, advantages, and limitations of existing systems. It also provides insights into potential improvements and innovations that can be incorporated into the proposed system.

2.2

Research Papers Reviewed

Paper	Year	Method	Limitation
Design of Online Service Marketplaces	2020	E-commerce architecture pattern analysis	Doesn't address freelancer-specific package pricing
Trust & Reputation Systems in E-Commerce	2021	Rating-aggregation and weighted-review model	Vulnerable to fake reviews without verification
Real-Time Chat Systems using AJAX Polling	2021	Polling-based asynchronous messaging	Higher server load compared to WebSockets
Dispute Resolution in Peer-to-Peer Platforms	2022	Rule-based admin arbitration workflow	Manual review doesn't scale with high order volume
Dummy Payment Simulation for Academic Systems	2022	State-machine based payment-status mock	Not suitable for production financial transactions
Gig Economy Platform Case Study: Fiverr & Upwork	2023	Comparative feature and commission analysis	Focused on global platforms, not local/small- scale use

2.3

Existing Systems

- **The major existing freelance platforms include:**
-
- Fiverr – Focuses on service-based listings with fixed pricing.
- Upwork – Provides a bidding system for freelancers and clients.
- Freelancer – Offers competitive bidding and project-based hiring.
- Toptal – Focuses on high-quality professionals with strict screening.

2.4

Comparative Analysis

Existing System	Advantages	Limitations
Fiverr	Simple package-based gig catalogue	High commission, not customizable
Upwork	Good for large, negotiated projects	Complex bidding flow, steep fees
Freelancer.com	Large freelancer pool, contests	Cluttered UI, aggressive upselling
Informal Social Groups	Free, zero setup	No tracking, no trust, no dispute handling

2.5

Research Gap

- **The analysis of existing systems reveals several gaps:**
-
- High commission fees reduce freelancer earnings.
- Complex interfaces make it difficult for beginners to use the platform.
- Limited support for local freelancers and small-scale projects.
- Lack of personalized recommendations for users.
- Insufficient focus on user-friendly design and accessibility.

2.6

Proposed Solution

- **The proposed system aims to overcome the limitations of existing platforms by providing**:
-
- Easy user registration and authentication.
- Detailed freelancer profiles with portfolios.
- Simple project posting and bidding mechanisms.
- Secure messaging system for communication.
- Integrated online payment gateway.
- Transparent rating and review system.
- Admin dashboard for monitoring and management.

2.7

Innovation Aspect

1

Package-based gig pricing
Basic/Standard/Premium tiers per gig, similar to commercial platforms but fully customizable.

2

Integrated dispute handling
Admin panel to view, moderate and resolve reported or disputed orders directly.

3

Academic-friendly payment mock
Dummycheckout removes theKYCbarrier
while preserving a realistic payment-status flow.

4

Lightweight AJAX chat
Per-order messaging without needing a heavier WebSocket infrastructure.

CHAPTER 3

Requirement Analysis

Stakeholders, functional and non-functional needs, technology stack and feasibility

3.1

Stakeholders

1

Client
Registers, browses gigs, places orders, chats, pays and leaves reviews.

2

Freelancer
Creates gig listings, manages orders, delivers work and earns from completed orders.

3

Admin
Manages users and categories, approves gigs, and resolves disputes.

4

Development & QA team
Builds, tests and maintains the platform through the project timeline.

3.2

Functional Requirements

- **The system must provide the following functionalities:**
-
- User Registration and Login with authentication.
- Freelancer Profile Management including skills and portfolio.
- Project Posting by clients with detailed descriptions.
- Project Bidding by freelancers.
- Messaging System for communication between users.
- Online Payment Integration for secure transactions.
- Rating and Review System for feedback.
- Admin Dashboard for system monitoring and control.

3.3

Non-Functional Requirements

- **The system should meet the following quality requirements**:
-
- High Security to protect user data and transactions.
- Fast Performance for smooth user experience.
- User-Friendly Interface for easy navigation.
- Reliability to ensure consistent system operation.
- Scalability to handle increasing users and data.
- Data Backup and Recovery for system safety.

3.4

Hardware Requirements

- Intel Core i3/i5 Processor or higher
- Minimum 4 GB RAM (8 GB recommended)
- At least 100 GB storage space
- Stable internet connection

3.5

Software Requirements

- Operating System: Windows 10/11 or Linux
- Development Tools: Visual Studio Code
- Database: MySQL
- Server: XAMPP or similar
- Browser: Google Chrome or any modern browser

3.6

Technology Stack

1

Frontend
HTML, CSS and JavaScript for the client- facing UI, including AJAX for live chat.

2

Backend
PHP handling authentication, gig, order, payment and admin logic.

3

Database
MySQL storing users, gigs, packages, orders, payments, messages, reviews and deliveries.

4

Extras
Chart.js for admin analytics; PHPMailer for optional email notifications.

3.7

Feasibility Study

- **Technical Feasibility:**
- The technologies required for development are widely available and well-documented, making implementation feasible.

- **Economic Feasibility:**
- The project can be developed using open-source tools, reducing overall cost.

- **Operational Feasibility:**
- The system is easy to use and can be adopted by users with basic technical knowledge.

- **Schedule Feasibility:**
- The project can be completed within the given academic timeline with proper planning.

3.8

Constraints

- Requires a stable internet connection for operation.
- Integration of secure payment gateways may involve additional complexity.
- User verification is necessary to prevent fraudulent activities.
- Regular maintenance and updates are required to ensure system performance and security.

Thank You

Chapters1–3covered:Introduction,Literature Survey and Requirement Analysis for the SkillHub Marketplace project.